

# Location Choices of Community Banks and Redlining: The case of Minority Depository Institutions

Noara Razzak \*

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## Abstract

I study the proximity of mission-oriented community banks, Minority Depository Institutions (MDIs) to historically segregated urban neighborhoods. To achieve this, I apply a Poisson Generalized Estimating Equation (GEE) framework to investigate whether MDIs are more likely to locate in historically “redlined” census tracts based on Home Owners’ Loan Corporation (HOLC) residential security maps, compared to non-MDIs. I find the expected number of Black MDIs increase 13-15 percent, whereas those of non-MDI banks decrease 2-3 percent for each point increase in the tracts’ HOLC scores. I also find Asian MDIs and Hispanic MDIs location choices remain negatively correlated with the scores. Rather, their expected numbers increase 4 percent and 1.2 percent for each percent increase in Asian and Spanish speakers at the tract level respectively. The findings reflect how historical federal policies still shape the banking landscape and how Black-owned banks, co-exist with larger banks in their local markets.

**JEL Classification Codes:** G20, G21 , R12

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\*John E. Walker Department of Economics, School of Business, Clemson University, Clemson, South Carolina, 29634-1309, USA; email nrzzak@clemson.edu. I want to thank my advisor, Howard Bodenhorn, and members of the Dissertation Committee, the Public Workshop and the IO Workshop for their valuable feedback.